Palm OS Programming Recipes

Recipe: Selector Triggers

Selector Triggers signal to the user that tapping them will bring up another dialog in order to enter the data they "contain". Selector triggers are actually controls that look like a label surrounded by a dotted rectangle.

To create a selector trigger that lets the user enter a date, do the following in Constructor:

1. Drag out a Selector Trigger object, place it on your form. The standard height is 12 for the standard font; set the other dimensions as you wish. Typically you would place it to the right of a right-justified label which is in the Bold font and ends with a colon, e.g. "Set Date:". Line up the baselines of the text of both objects.
2. The trigger's default settings should be Usable, Anchor Left, and Standard font.
3. Set the object identifier and initial label as you choose; for this example use "Date" as the object identifier and an empty string for the label, since we will initialize it at runtime.

To initialize the label of the trigger at runtime, use code as follows in your frmOpenEvent:

```
ControlType *ctlP;
FormType* frmP = FrmGetActiveForm();

ctlP = (ControlType *) FrmGetObjectPtr(frmP,
               FrmGetObjectIndex(frmP, MainDateSelTrigger));
StrCopy(gDateTrigger, "None");
CtlSetLabel(ctlP, gDateTrigger);
```

Note that this code uses a global variable "gDateTrigger" which is a buffer containing the trigger's label. When you call CtlSetLabel, the string is not copied, so you must keep the buffer valid for the life of the object.

When the user taps the trigger, you will get a ctlSelectEvent. Here is how to handle it if you were to prompt the user for the date. A real application would presumably keep the "thisDay" value for later use as well.

```
case ctlSelectEvent:
   if (eventP->data.ctlSelect.controlID == MainDateSelTrigger) {
      DateTimeType thisDay;
      ControlType *ctlP;
      FormType *frmP;

      TimSecondsToDateTime(TimGetSeconds(), &thisDay);
      if (SelectDay(selectDayByDay, &thisDay.month,
            &thisDay.day, &thisDay.year, "Set Date")) {
         DateToAscii(thisDay.month, thisDay.day, thisDay.year,
                     (DateFormatType) PrefGetPreference(prefDateFormat),
                     gDateTrigger);
         frmP = FrmGetActiveForm();
         ctlP = (ControlType *) FrmGetObjectPtr(frmP,
               FrmGetObjectIndex(frmP, MainDateSelTrigger));
         CtlSetLabel(ctlP, gDateTrigger);
      }
   }
   break;
```